

Antitank Weapons

The first effective antitank weapons were steel-cored rifle bullets for the 7.92mm Mauser rifle that proved able to pierce the armor of Mark I and Mark II tanks. Mauserwerke was then instructed to develop something more powerful, and responded with the first purpose-built AT weapon—the 13.2mm Tankgewehr M1918 rifle. However, it was not until 1928 that a true antitank gun, the German PAK36, appeared. It was soon adopted as a tank gun, as were other nations' towed AT guns, such as the

British 2- and 6-pounders. From then on, as armor grew thicker, AT guns became more powerful and significantly larger, culminating in the 17-pounder, the PAK43, and the Soviet ZiS-2. Meanwhile, more effective and lighter infantry AT weapons, including mines, grenades, and recoilless guns, were being developed, as were vehicles designed specifically to hunt and kill tanks. Since the 1960s, guided missiles, whether carried by infantry or on vehicles, have also become increasingly common.



Hawkins No. 75 grenade

The No. 75 could be used as a grenade or, more effectively, as a mine.



RKG-3 grenade

On being released, a parachute deployed from the RKG, ensuring that it struck nose-down.



Tellermine 35

Filled with 12 lb (5.5 kg) of TNT, the Tellermine 35 was triggered by 198 lb (90 kg) of pressure.



Mauser T-Gewehr M1918

The single-shot, bolt-action T-Gewehr 18 weighed 41 lb (18.5 kg) loaded and with its bipod in place. Its round could pierce .87 in (22 mm) of armor at 330 ft (100 m), but its recoil was fearsome.



Boys Mk 1 antitank rifle

Though able to pierce only 0.9 in (23 mm) of armor at 300 ft (90 m), the .55-in-caliber Boys AT Rifle, skillfully used, proved effective against German PzKpfw IIs during the Battle of France in 1940.



Panzerfaust

This simple rocket-propelled grenade launcher was very effective at close range. Toward the end of World War II, it was issued to German troops in large numbers.



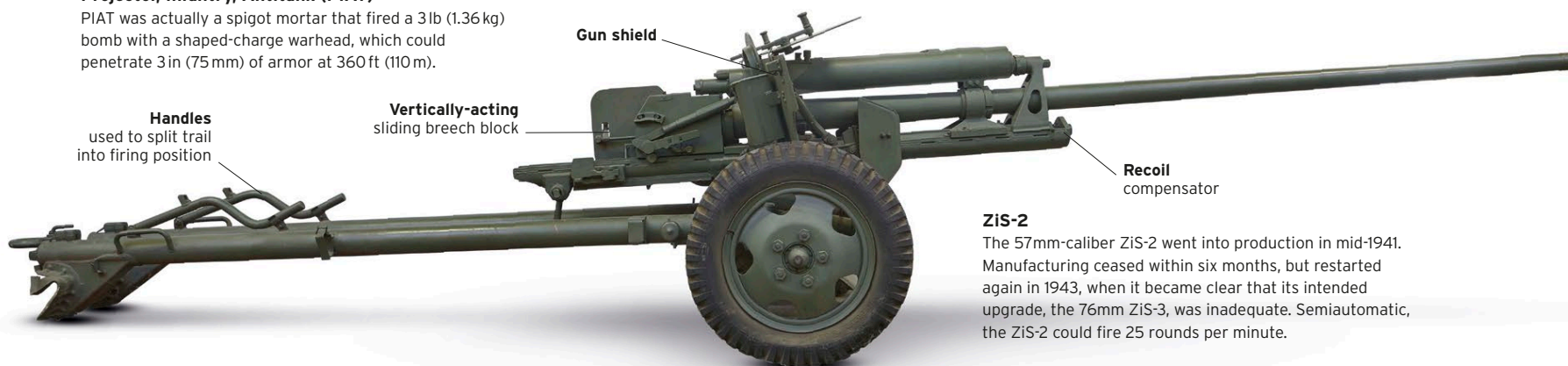
Projector, Infantry, Antitank (PIAT)

PIAT was actually a spigot mortar that fired a 3 lb (1.36 kg) bomb with a shaped-charge warhead, which could penetrate 3 in (75 mm) of armor at 360 ft (110 m).



RPG-7

The RPG-7's two-stage propellant charge gives it a range of over 3,300 ft (1,000 m)—at which its HEAT warhead can still penetrate 20 in (500 mm) of armor.



ZiS-2

The 57mm-caliber ZiS-2 went into production in mid-1941. Manufacturing ceased within six months, but restarted again in 1943, when it became clear that its intended upgrade, the 76mm ZiS-3, was inadequate. Semiautomatic, the ZiS-2 could fire 25 rounds per minute.